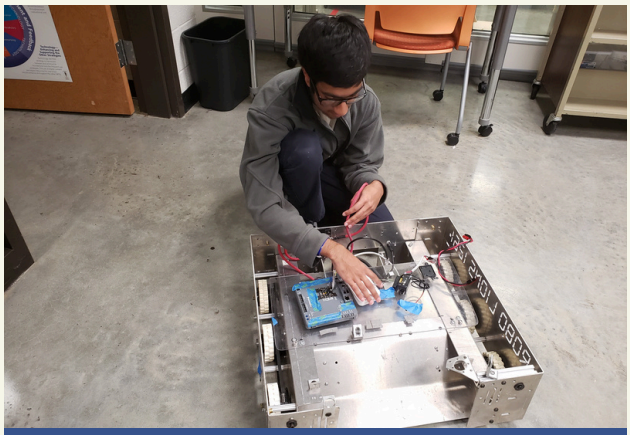
TEJAS SHAH

MARCH 12, 2026 ISSUE #27



ALCOHOLIC ASSERTIONS

While at work dinners, I prefer not to drink with co-workers simply because it is not an environment I feel comfortable in and I feel the need to retain my full awareness and rational thinking. But my co-workers treated it like I genuinely hated them when I said I do drink but just preferred not to at work dinners. All throughout my life, people have made alcohol seem very one-dimensional: either you drink and you're chill, or you don't and you're uptight. Lots of people have been surprised to hear that I drink, which makes sense because those same people who view it in that one-dimensional way are people I don't care to drink with (and thus don't feel comfortable with). I've never had a solid relationship start off with alcohol, that always comes after the fact, so this system of using alcohol as a way to get to know someone really doesn't sit well with me, and is truthfully difficult to navigate.

SHI THAT HAPPENED

- Got Dosas with Venmo! And then went back to her apartment and watched Big Bang Theory, great time!
- Went to a Hookah bar for work, twice! Did not have a great time!
- Getting like daily nosebleeds so lowkey a lil concerned about that but doctor said it wasn't that deep so
- Venmo got me a free CapitalOne cafe coffee shoutout her fr I was feeling sick tho so I got a green tea but still shits lit

NIGHTMARE OF THE WEEK

I have very confusing feelings about work. I think some underlying traumas from other workplaces like robotics and Delta are slowly cropping up, where it feels like people are just waiting for you to mess up. I don't really feel like I'm being coached/mentored all that much, I kind of just do work and then others build upon it, and present it from there. If there's an issue or something is not ideal, I am not told how it should be improved, and therefore I don't really *learn*. They just kind of expected me to be good at everything from the start, which I am not and no one is.